

We Thought He Was Joking

Story Bible (Version 1)

Genre

Psychological Mystery • Thriller • Tragedy

Core Theme

A story about regret.

Nobody intended for anyone to die.

Everyone had a chance to prevent it.

Nobody realized it until it was too late.

The mystery is not simply "**Who killed him?**"

The real question is:

"How did five ordinary people make enough small mistakes to create one irreversible tragedy?"

Main Characters

1. Narrator

Personality

- Quiet
- Observant
- Rational
- Often overthinks situations
- Doesn't like interfering in other people's problems

Role

The audience experiences the story through him.

He is the one being interviewed in the trailer.

He slowly pieces together everyone's versions of the events.

Biggest Regret

"I should've taken him seriously."

2. Friend (Victim)

Personality

- Funny
- Charismatic
- Intelligent
- Loves dark humor
- Constantly jokes about crime, death, and disappearing
- Never lets people know when he's actually serious

Role

The emotional center of the story.

Everyone misunderstands him.

By the time he finally speaks seriously...

Nobody believes him.

Biggest Regret

He never learned how to communicate without hiding behind jokes.

3. Roommate

Personality

- Practical
- Calm
- Sarcastic

- Doesn't like unnecessary drama

Role

Knows the friend better than anyone.

Because he's heard these jokes hundreds of times...

He's the first person to dismiss them.

Biggest Regret

He walked away during the final argument.

4. Friend's Girlfriend

Personality

- Caring
- Independent
- Emotionally exhausted
- Honest but guarded

Role

She understands the friend's emotional struggles better than anyone.

But after months of emotional ups and downs...

She stops recognizing when something is actually wrong.

Biggest Regret

She stopped asking, "Are you okay?"

5. Neighbor

Personality

- Quiet
- Observant
- Keeps to himself

Role

He isn't part of the friend group.

He only knows them through:

- Arguments
- Laughter
- Doors slamming
- Conversations through the walls

His perspective is incomplete.

Biggest Regret

He heard shouting that night.

He almost knocked.

Instead...

He assumed it was another argument.

Story Timeline

One Month Before

The friend starts making increasingly disturbing jokes.

Everyone laughs.

Nobody thinks twice.

Three Weeks Before

The jokes become more specific.

Examples:

"One day you'll all remember me."

"If something ever happens, don't pretend you never saw the signs."

Everyone laughs again.

Two Weeks Before

The narrator notices the friend becoming quieter after every joke.

The roommate notices he barely sleeps.

The girlfriend notices he's changing.

Nobody connects these observations.

One Week Before

Arguments between the friend and his girlfriend become more frequent.

Nothing physical.

Just emotional.

The roommate becomes frustrated.

The neighbor gets used to hearing them.

Three Days Before

The friend says something that genuinely unsettles the narrator.

For a brief moment...

The narrator considers asking,

"Are you serious?"

Instead...

He laughs.

The friend laughs too.

But his smile disappears first.

The Final Night

Everyone remembers it differently.

Every version is truthful.

Every version is incomplete.

Narrator's Version

The evening felt normal.

The friend seemed quieter than usual.

Nothing appeared dangerous.

Roommate's Version

The argument wasn't unusual.

It had happened before.

He left the apartment to let everyone cool down.

Girlfriend's Version

She wanted to leave.

The friend wanted to continue the conversation.

She remembers frustration.

Not fear.

Neighbor's Version

He hears:

- Raised voices
- Something hitting the floor
- Silence

Then...

A door opens.

Footsteps.

Another door closes.

Nothing else.

What Actually Happened

For the first time...

The friend stops joking.

He finally speaks honestly.

He admits he's overwhelmed.

He feels trapped.

He wants someone to understand.

Unfortunately...

Everyone believes it's another joke.

The conversation becomes heated.

Someone grabs someone's arm.

Someone pulls away.

The friend loses balance.

He falls.

His head strikes the sharp corner of a table.

Silence.

Nobody intended this.

Nobody expected it.

It happens within seconds.

After the Accident

Panic.

Nobody reacts the same way.

The narrator freezes.

The roommate rushes back.

The girlfriend repeatedly calls the friend's name.

The neighbor waits...

Unsure whether he should interfere.

Those few moments become everyone's greatest regret.

The Trailer

Months later..

The narrator sits in front of a camera.

He's asked to tell the story.

He struggles to speak.

Eventually he says:

"He told us exactly what he was going to do."

"We just thought he was joking."

Cut to black.

Series Title appears.

Core Mystery

Throughout the series, viewers continuously ask:

- Who is lying?
- Which version is closest to the truth?
- Who caused the accident?
- Could it have been prevented?
- Who deserves the blame?

By the finale...

There is no single villain.

Only five people carrying different pieces of the same regret.

Final Message

Sometimes tragedy doesn't happen because one person makes a terrible decision.

Sometimes...

It happens because **everyone makes a small one.**